

GALLERY DUTCH ART

The Art of Value

How luxury properties use art to command premium prices

gallerydutchart.nl

Module 2 — Building Your Art Strategy

2.1 — Start with brand & narrative

Before a single artwork is chosen, answer one question: *what story should this property tell?* A beach resort that whispers "barefoot luxury" needs a different art language than a city hotel that signals "power and culture." Write a one-paragraph art narrative — three or four adjectives plus the feeling you want guests to have on arrival. Every later decision is measured against it. If a beautiful piece doesn't serve the narrative, it doesn't belong.

2.2 — The space-by-space art plan

Walk the property as a guest does and map the *emotional arc*: arrival (statement), journey (rhythm), arrival in the room (intimacy), social spaces (energy), wellness (calm). For each zone, note the role art should play, the scale, and the mood. This plan — not a shopping list — is the backbone of a coherent collection and the document you'll brief artists and consultants with.

2.3 — Setting the right budget & tiers

Split the budget into three tiers: **hero pieces** (1–3 unforgettable works that carry the brand, ~40–50% of budget), **supporting collection** (coherent work across guest spaces, ~35–45%), and **accents** (smaller pieces, ~10–15%). Decide tiers *before* you fall in love with anything. As a rough hospitality benchmark, art often runs 1–3% of FF&E budget — but the hero pieces are where the disproportionate return lives.

2.4 — The briefing template

A great brief saves money and time. Include: the art narrative; the space and its role; dimensions, sightlines and lighting; brand and material palette; budget tier; timeline and install constraints; and three reference images of the *feeling* (not works to copy). Hand this to any artist, gallery or consultant and you'll get sharper proposals and fewer expensive misunderstandings. (*Downloadable one-page brief included.*)

Module 3 — Sourcing & Curation

3.1 — Originals, editions, prints & commissions

Understand your options and what each buys you. **Originals**: maximum prestige and asset value, highest cost. **Limited editions**: prestige at lower cost, good for multi-room consistency. **Open prints**: budget-friendly accents. **Commissions**: bespoke work made for your space and story — the most powerful tool for a hero piece, and impossible for a competitor to replicate. Most strong programmes mix all four by tier.

3.2 — Working with artists & galleries

Galleries give you curation, provenance and reliability; working directly with artists can give you access and value but needs more management. Either way, agree scope, deliverables, timeline, edition terms and *who owns what* up front. Build relationships, not transactions — the best access (and pricing) comes to clients artists trust.

3.3 — Provenance, contracts & licensing

Protect the property as an asset. For every significant piece, keep documentation of authenticity and provenance. In contracts, be explicit about: ownership, the right to reproduce images (your marketing will want to), copyright (the artist usually keeps it), site-specificity, and what happens on resale or renovation. This is unglamorous and absolutely essential.

3.4 — Curating a coherent collection

Curation is editing. A collection feels intentional when works share a thread — palette, theme, era, medium or a conceptual idea — even across very different pieces. Lay everything out together before committing; remove anything that's merely "nice." The test: could a guest sense a point of view without reading a label? If yes, you've curated. If no, you've decorated.

Module 4 — Placement, Production & Installation

4.1 — Space by space

Each zone has rules. **Lobby**: one hero, high impact, visible from the entrance. **Suites**: calmer, tactile, personal — nothing that disturbs rest. **F&B**: characterful and conversation-starting, durable against heat and grease. **Spa & wellness**: serene, often abstract, chosen for humidity. **Outdoor & pool**: weather-resilient sculpture and installations. Match the art's *job* to the room's *job*.

4.2 — Lighting, scale & materials

The most common waste of money is great art, badly lit or wrongly sized. Budget for proper art lighting from day one and involve the lighting designer early. Scale boldly — under-sized art on a big wall looks timid and cheap. In hospitality, favour durable, low-maintenance materials and protective finishes; this is a working building, not a museum vitrine.

4.3 — Monumental & digital installations

A signature installation — sculptural, kinetic or digital — is often the single best ROI move: it becomes the photographed, shared, "you have to see it" moment. These require early engineering, structural and power planning, and a realistic maintenance plan. Plan them at design stage, never as an afterthought, and budget for upkeep (especially anything digital).

4.4 — Logistics, framing, insurance & install

The last 10% makes or breaks the result. Plan crating, transport, customs (critical for international work), conservation-grade framing, insurance in transit and on-site, and a professional install crew. Build art install into the construction programme so walls, fixings, power and lighting are ready. A missed fixing detail can delay a hero piece for weeks.

Module 5 — Impact, Care & Working with a Consultant

5.1 — Measuring impact (KPIs)

What gets measured gets funded next time. Track: social mentions and tags of specific works; press and editorial pickups; guest feedback and review mentions; dwell time and spend in art-led spaces; and, for branded residences, sales-gallery conversion. You won't get a perfect attribution model — you don't need one. A handful of directional signals justifies the programme and guides the next.

5.2 — Maintenance, rotation & collection management

Art is an asset that needs care: cleaning, condition checks, lighting upkeep, and a register of what you own, where it is, and its value. **Rotation** keeps repeat guests engaged and is the foundation of an "art-as-a-service" model. Assign ownership of the collection internally, or outsource it — but don't let a six-figure asset drift.

5.3 — When to DIY vs hire a consultant

Do it yourself when the scope is small, the budget is modest, and you have time and taste in-house. Bring in a consultant when the stakes are high: hero pieces, commissions, multi-asset developments, tight construction timelines, or when art needs to perform commercially. A good consultant pays for themselves through better sourcing, fewer mistakes and faster delivery.

5.4 — Your action plan + next steps

Your 30-day plan: (1) write your art narrative; (2) map the space-by-space plan; (3) set budget tiers; (4) shortlist 2–3 hero opportunities; (5) brief a curator or consultant. When you're ready to move from plan to execution — concept, curation and installation — that's exactly what Gallery Dutch Art delivers. Start with an **Art Concept Sprint** to turn this course into a concrete proposal for your property.

Bonus 1 — One-page briefing template

- Property & space: ____
- Art narrative (3–4 adjectives + desired feeling): ____
- Role of art in this space: ____
- Dimensions / sightlines / wall + lighting: ____
- Brand & material palette: ____
- Budget tier (hero / supporting / accent): ____
- Timeline & install constraints: ____
- 3 reference images (feeling, not to copy): ____

Bonus 2 — KPI tracker (starter)

Signal	How to track	Cadence
Social tags of artworks	Search location + hashtags	Monthly
Press / editorial	Media monitoring	Quarterly
Review mentions of art	Review tool keyword search	Monthly
Dwell & spend in art spaces	POS + observation	Quarterly
Sales-gallery conversion	CRM (residences)	Per phase

